Level 1, older clients

Level 1, older clients, 50 min

1. Footwork — 7 min, Reformer



Footwork: arches, parallel — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, par; Wrap the bar, press out; Knees track over 2nd toe



Footwork: calf stretch under the bar — **1 min, 3 slow holds**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Legs long, heels under FB; Hold 3 breaths, lift, repeat; Soft knees if tight



Footwork: toes, Pilates V — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Heels together, toes apart (V); Turn out from the hips; Squeeze inner thighs out



Footwork: heels wide, parallel — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Heels wide on FB, par; Knees over ankles; Even weight both feet

2. Bridging — 4 min, Reformer



Hinge bridge, feet on footbar — **1½ min, x8**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, hip wd; Lift hips as one piece; Hold, lower in one piece



Articulated bridge, feet on footbar — **2½ min, x6**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Imp, peel spine up (art); Hold at top, long thighs; Roll down bone by bone

3. Abs — 4 min, Reformer



Chest lift, feet on footbar — **2 min, x8**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, hands behind head; Exh, HNS curl up; Inh hold, Exh lower



Hundred prep, feet on footbar — **2 min, 50 to 100 beats**
Springs: Light, 1 red
Arms in straps, feet on FB; HNS, arms press to hips; Pump arms, Inh 5, Exh 5

4. Lower body — 6 min, Standing (no equipment)



Standing squat — **2 min, x10**
Feet hip wd, arms forward; Sit back, chest long; Stand tall, squeeze glutes



Squat with overhead reach — **2 min, x10**
Feet hip wd, arms forward; Sit back into squat; Stand, reach arms up, ribs down



Standing heel raises — **2 min, x10**
Stand tall, hand on frame if needed; Rise to balls of feet; Lower slow

5. Upper body — 5 min, Standing (no equipment)



Standing overhead press with light weights — **1½ min, x10**
Stand tall, wts at shoulders; Press up, ribs down; Lower slow



Standing magic circle press — **1½ min, x10**
Stand tall, MC at chest; Squeeze, then raise overhead; Ribs down

Standing biceps with light weights — **2 min, x10**
Stand tall, wts in hands; Elbows by ribs, curl up; Lower slow

Second half

From minute 26. 0 equipment changes, 7 spring changes

6. Side and lateral work — 4 min, Reformer



Seated side reach with magic circle — **1½ min, x5 ea**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall, MC overhead; Reach up and over to one side; Both sit bns stay down



Mermaid — **2½ min, x4 ea**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Side sit, near hand on FB; Push carr out, arm overhead; Long side bend, return

7. Full body integration — 6 min, Reformer



Seated roll back with straps — **2½ min, x6**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Sit tall facing straps, hold straps; Exh, roll back to C-curve; Inh hold, Exh roll up tall



Standing hinge at the footbar — **1½ min, x6**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Stand, hands on FB; Walk back, hinge to flat back; Long spine, soft knees



Quadruped hold on the carriage — **2 min, 5 slow breaths x3**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Knees on carr, hands on FB; Long flat back; Tiny press back, hold, return

8. Prone work for the spine — 4 min, Reformer



Cat and cow on the carriage — **2 min, x5**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Hands and knees, hands on FB; Round up, then lengthen; Slow with breath



Swan prep on the carriage — **2 min, x6**
Springs: Light, 1 red
Lie face down, hands on FB; Press bar, lift chest a little; Lower slow, long neck

9. Stretch — 5 min, Reformer



Inner thigh stretch in straps — **1½ min, 3 breaths**
Springs: Light, 1 red
Both feet in straps; Open legs wide, hold; Close slow



Hamstring stretch in straps — **1½ min, 3 breaths ea**
Springs: Light, 1 red
One foot in strap, leg up; Other foot on FB; Soft knee, breathe, switch

Seated chest opener — **2 min, 3 breaths**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Sit facing FB, straps in hands; Let arms open back; Lift chest, breathe

10. Closing pull down and wind down — 5 min, Reformer



Pelvic tilts on the carriage — **1½ min, x8**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, neut; Exh, imp, Inh neut; Slow, easy breath



Figure 4 stretch, foot on footbar — **1½ min, 3 breaths ea**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
One foot on FB; Cross ankle over knee; Bend in a little, switch



Seated spine stretch on the carriage — **2 min, x4**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall facing FB, legs wide; Hands on FB, round forward; Stack up tall

Key. HNS Head and shoulders lifted; **FB** Footbar; **carr** Carriage; **par** Parallel legs; **V** Pilates V, heels together, toes apart; **neut** Neutral pelvis and spine; **imp** Imprint, low back gently toward the mat; **ea** Each side; **x** Repetitions, so x8 means 8 times; **Inh** Inhale; **Exh** Exhale; **sit bns** Sit bones; **hip wd** Hip width apart; **art** Articulate, one bone at a time; **wts** Light weights; **MC** Magic circle. Springs: red heavy, blue medium, yellow light. Older clients start lighter. Start at the lighter load. Add spring only if form stays clean.